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Retailing

Costco just went from 7 to 19 fulfillment centers in one year

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Twelve new fulfillment centers opened in the last year, which not only helps with the customer experience, but helps Costco rein in expenses associated with e-commerce, CFO Richard Galanti says.

LUKE SHARRETT | BLOOMBERG

By Coral Garnick – Associate Editor, Puget Sound Business Journal

May 26, 2017, 11:51am PDT
Updated May 30, 2017, 12:25pm PDT

Costco Wholesale has been increasing inventory for e-commerce products and

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Other takeaways about Costco's e-commerce business:

- Costco currently offers somewhere between 8,000 to 10,000 items online.
- Instacart now operates in 240 Costco warehouses, up from 132 a year ago.
- Costco reported 11 percent e-commerce sales growth year over year, compared to say Wal-Mart, which reported 63 percent online sales growth.

Costco also recently tapped technology executive Kenneth Denman for an open board of directors seat in March, which may be an indication that the company is looking to further improve its digital business.

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